

# COVER LETTER

ANNA BOGOUN

I'm an American-born character designer and animator currently studying Animation & Visual Effects at VŠKK in Prague, with a background in illustration and traditional art. Instinctively, my art and design sense has always tipped toward kids' animated films, with simple shapes and strong silhouettes.

Ever since I was a child, I loved fairytale based animated films. The two films I had on rotation on the eight hour flight to and from Europe to visit family were Cartoon Saloon's *Song of the Sea* and Filmax Animation's *Nocturna*. That pull toward a certain kind of animated film never went away, and Laika's work sits squarely in that same vein for me. I was obsessed with *Boxtrolls*, fell in love with the character designs and sets of *Paranorman*, and watched every behind-the-scenes and making-of video for *Missing Link*.

I enjoy having clear goals, and being part of a program that is set on growth, learning and becoming the best version of myself in terms of art and design is a perfect opportunity. I won't lie and say that having a Laika Studio's experience on my resume and connections with people from that environment isn't also what I, and many others, hope to attain, but after my intensive last summer with Len Simon at Anomalia, I know firsthand just how much someone can grow when given the opportunity, no matter how big or small. And I will not be one to squander it.

Thank you for your consideration.